

# Git in five minutes

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# Why version control?



## A FAMILIAR FOLDER

```
thesis.tex  
thesis_final.tex  
thesis_final_v2.tex  
thesis_final_really.tex
```

Which version did I send my supervisor?

What changed since then?

Version control keeps a history of recorded versions.

# How Git helps

A **repository** is your project together with its Git history.

## 1 / EDIT

### Your files

Save your changes in the editor.

## 2 / SELECT

### Staging area

```
git add
```

Select current content for the next commit.

## 3 / RECORD

### Commit

```
git commit
```

Record a snapshot with a message.

Saving a file does not create a commit.

Edit after `git add`? Add again to include the later edits.

Commits stay on your computer. An external backup is separate.

# The first commit

Start in a new folder containing `manuscript.tex`.

```
git init
git status
git add manuscript.tex
git status
git commit -m "Record initial manuscript draft"
git status
git log
```

**WATCH THE FILE**

Untracked

Staged

Committed

`status:` current state      `log:` recorded history